

# Carryover-sensitivity study: development-run review

96-cell grid, five analysis methods, 150 replicates per cell

pmsimstats team

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## 1 Overview

This document presents pipeline-verification results for the carryover-sensitivity manuscript from the development simulation run completed 2026-05-20. The run uses a 96-cell reduced Tier 1 grid (150 replicates per cell, MCSE  $\approx 0.041$  at  $p = 0.5$ ) and a 31-cell Tier 2 sensitivity grid. All figures and tables are computed inline from the development RDS files; nothing is loaded from pre-rendered figures or the shared `analysis/data/` summaries.

**Five analysis methods.** Beyond the three analysis-model specifications of the parent study, E1 (binary  $D_b$ ), E2 (exposure-weighted  $D_{bc}$ ), and E3 (lagged-treatment), this dev run carries two robust-inference analyses, both applied to the E2 ( $D_{bc}$ ) predictor. `lme+CR2` is the conditional `lme` fit with its model-based standard error replaced by a CR2 bias-reduced cluster-robust sandwich. `GEE+MD` is the marginal generalized-estimating-equations fit with a Mancl-DeRouen bias-corrected sandwich. The two robust analyses are produced by the `--robust` flag of the simulation drivers, in anticipation of carrying them into the production pipeline; their rationale and validation are documented in manuscript 10 (`analysis/report/10-interaction-test-calibration/`).

The purpose of this document is to verify that:

Table 1: Development-run metadata read from the output RDS files.

| Item                      | Value      |
|---------------------------|------------|
| Tier 1 cells              | 96         |
| Tier 1 reps/cell          | 150        |
| Tier 2 cells              | 31         |
| Tier 2 reps/cell          | 150        |
| Analysis methods per cell | 5          |
| Total Tier 1 rows         | 72000      |
| Total Tier 2 rows         | 23250      |
| Run date                  | 2026-05-21 |

- a) the  $E2 > E1 \approx E3$  power ranking is visible at 150 reps;
- b) the three model-based specifications are conservative under the null, while the robust analyses move the Type I error toward the nominal 0.05;
- c) lme+CR2 recovers the power lost to conservatism, while GEE+MD carries a modest residual efficiency cost as a marginal-model estimator;
- d) the Tier 2 sensitivity-block trends are plausible.

Precise point estimates should be drawn from the production run (500 reps, 540 cells) rather than from this document.

**Dev grid coverage.** The Tier 1 dev grid retains both DGP architectures and all three DGP decay forms (the primary axes), trimming secondary axes to two representative values each. `t1half` is reduced to  $\{0.0, 1.0\}$  weeks; design to  $\{\text{CO}, \text{Hybrid}\}$ ;  $N$  to  $\{35, 70\}$ ;  $c_{bm}$  to  $\{0.0, 0.45\}$ ; Weibull uses only  $k = 0.7$ . The OL+BDC design and  $k = 1.5$  Weibull shape are absent from the dev grid; any figure filtered to those levels will appear empty.

## 2 Tier 1 results

### 2.1 Headline performance at the reference cell

Table 2 shows the Morris-style performance measures at the reference cell (the covariance-moderation architecture, exponential DGP, Hybrid design,  $N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ ), for all five analysis methods at both carryover half-lives present in the dev grid.

### 2.2 Power by analysis method

### 2.3 Decay-form by analysis-method heatmap

### 2.4 Type I error control

The three model-based specifications E1, E2, and E3 sit visibly below the nominal 0.05 line in Figure 3, the conservatism diagnosed in manuscript 10 (`analysis/report/10-interaction-test-calibration/`); lme+CR2 and GEE+MD sit on or near it, confirming that the robust analyses recalibrate the interaction test. Figure 4 shows the same null cells split by DGP architecture rather than by design. Because the two architectures reduce to a bit-identical data-generating process when  $c_{bm} = 0$ , the Mean and Covariance panels are two samples from one distribution and should coincide up to Monte Carlo noise; that they do is a consistency check on the simulation.

### 2.5 Summary table: all cells at $N = 70$ , $c_{bm} = 0.45$ , Hybrid

Table 2: Reference-cell performance (the covariance-moderation architecture, exponential DGP, Hybrid,  $N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ ,  $n_{sim} = 150$ ). The lme+CR2 row shares the E2 interaction estimate (its bias and empirical SE track E2) and differs only in the standard error; GEE+MD is a separate marginal fit with its own estimate, modestly less efficient than the conditional lme. MCSEs are about twice those of the 500-rep production run.

| t1/2 | spec    | Power (MCSE)  | Bias (MCSE)    | Emp SE | Coverage | Non-conv |
|------|---------|---------------|----------------|--------|----------|----------|
| 0    | E1      | 0.967 (0.015) | +0.043 (0.071) | 0.870  | 0.953    | 0.000    |
| 0    | E2      | 0.967 (0.015) | +0.043 (0.071) | 0.870  | 0.953    | 0.000    |
| 0    | E3      | 0.967 (0.015) | +0.044 (0.071) | 0.866  | 0.953    | 0.000    |
| 0    | lme+CR2 | 0.987 (0.009) | +0.043 (0.071) | 0.873  | 0.906    | 0.007    |
| 0    | GEE+MD  | 0.960 (0.016) | +0.095 (0.074) | 0.908  | 0.913    | 0.000    |
| 1    | E1      | 0.727 (0.036) | +1.231 (0.065) | 0.792  | 0.767    | 0.000    |
| 1    | E2      | 0.873 (0.027) | +0.098 (0.081) | 0.997  | 1.000    | 0.000    |
| 1    | E3      | 0.720 (0.037) | +1.249 (0.066) | 0.804  | 0.767    | 0.000    |
| 1    | lme+CR2 | 0.893 (0.025) | +0.095 (0.082) | 0.999  | 0.946    | 0.007    |
| 1    | GEE+MD  | 0.847 (0.029) | +0.068 (0.086) | 1.058  | 0.960    | 0.000    |

#### Power vs carryover under matched exponential DGP

$N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ , 150 reps/cell (dev)

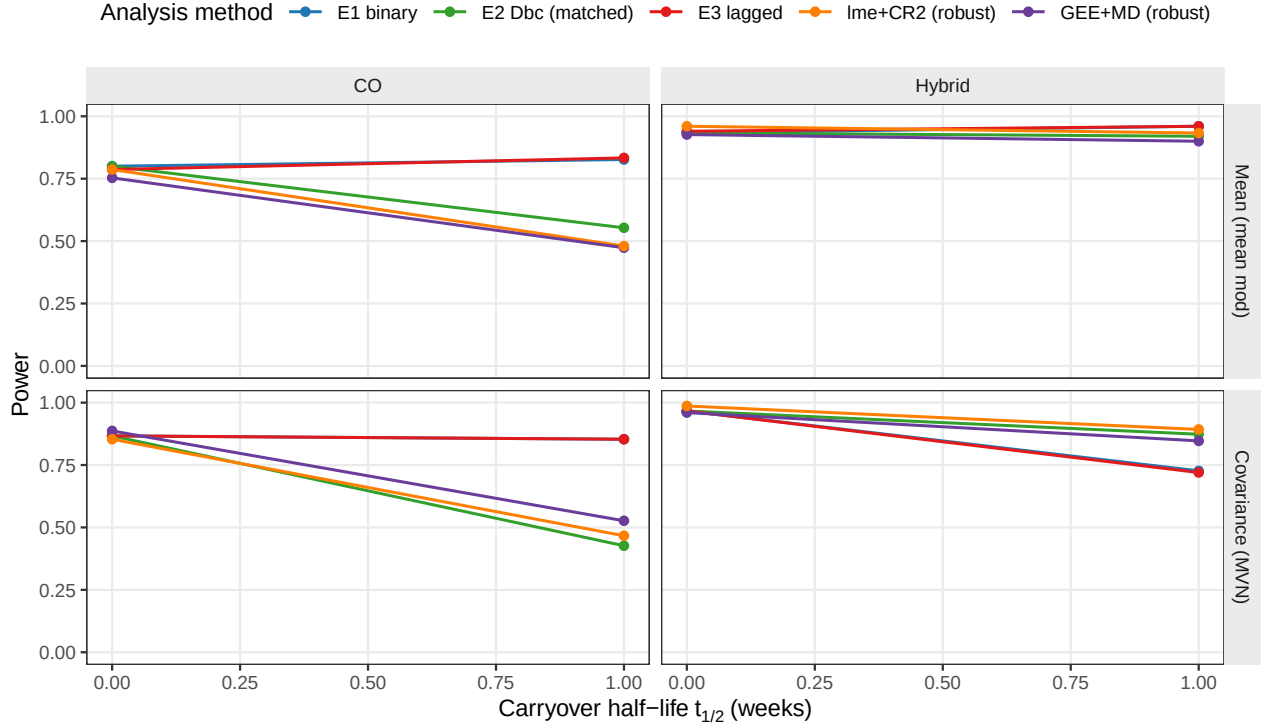


Figure 1: Power versus carryover half-life under the exponential DGP, stratified by architecture and design, for all five analysis methods. Dev grid: design in  $\{CO, Hybrid\}$  only;  $N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ , 150 reps per cell. lme+CR2 lifts power above E2 by recalibrating the conservative standard error; GEE+MD tracks just below E2, a modest residual efficiency cost of the marginal estimator relative to the conditional lme.

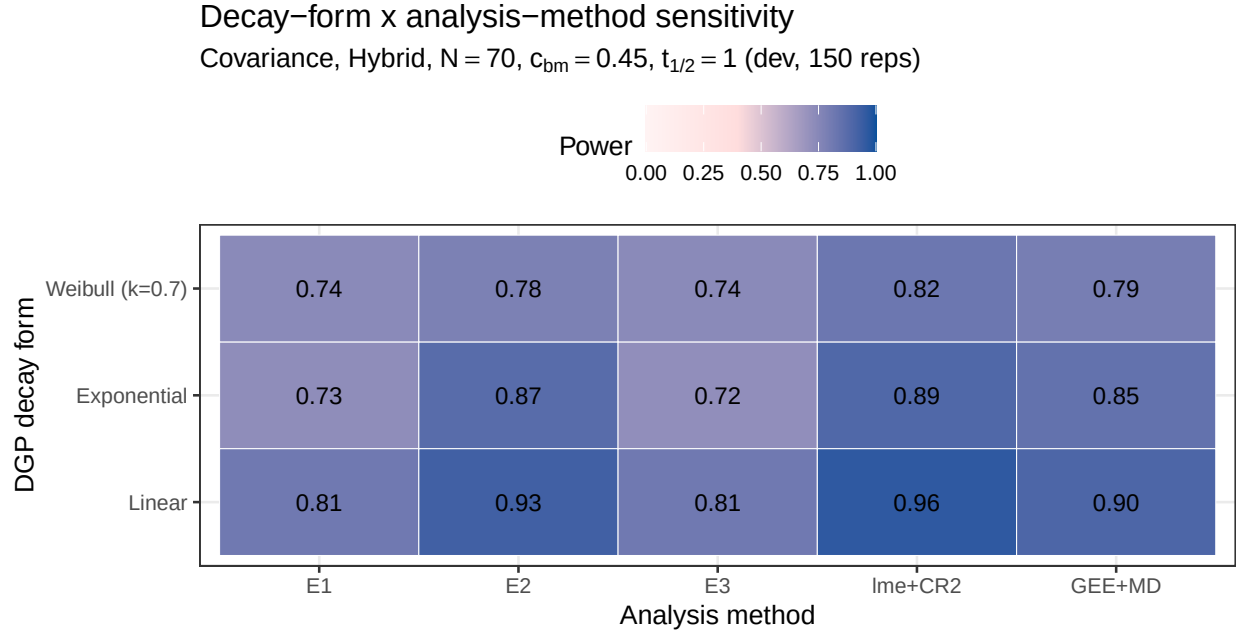


Figure 2: Power at the reference carryover cell ( $t_{1/2} = 1.0$  week, the covariance-moderation architecture, Hybrid design,  $N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ ) across DGP decay forms and the five analysis methods. The dev grid contains three DGP forms: Linear, Exponential, and Weibull  $k = 0.7$ .

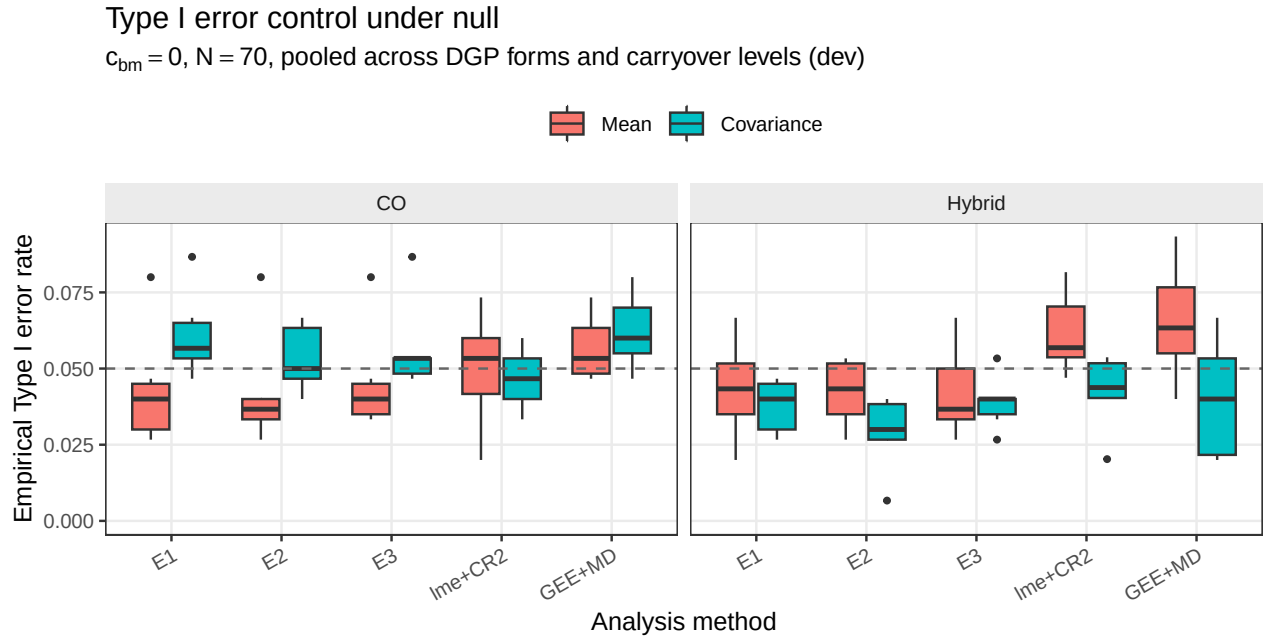


Figure 3: Empirical Type I error rates under the null ( $c_{bm} = 0$ ), pooled across DGP decay forms and carryover half-lives, stratified by design and analysis method.  $N = 70$ ; dashed line at nominal 0.05. The three model-based specifications sit below nominal; lme+CR2 sits near nominal; GEE+MD is near nominal under the Hybrid design but anti-conservative under CO.

### Type I error under null, split by architecture

$c_{bm} = 0$ ,  $N = 70$ , pooled across DGP forms and carryover levels (dev)

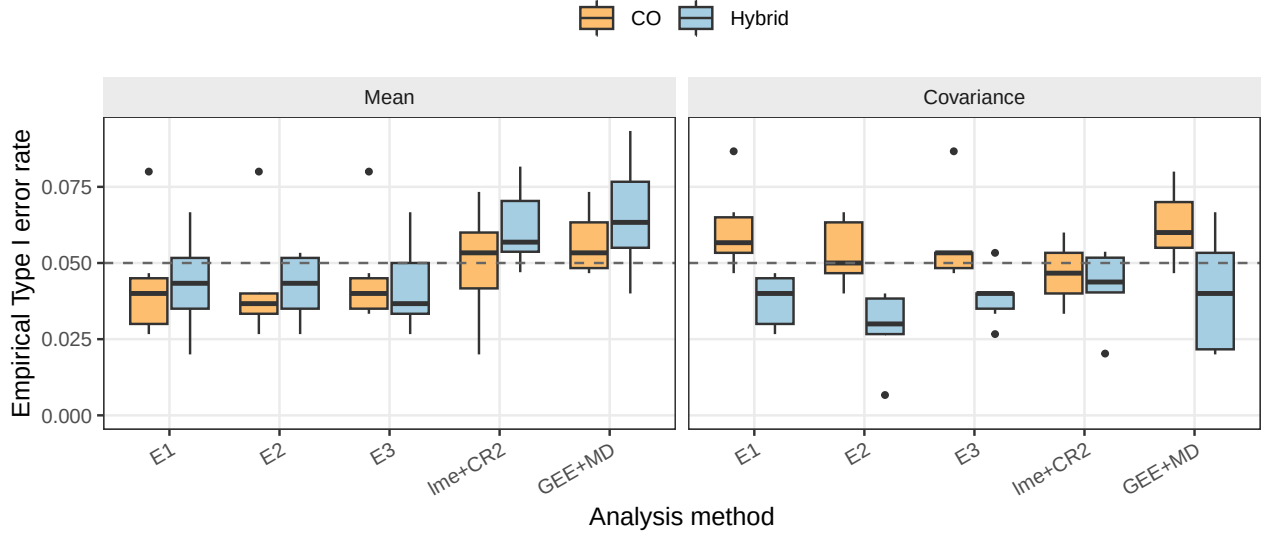


Figure 4: Empirical Type I error rates under the null ( $c_{bm} = 0$ ,  $N = 70$ ), the same null cells as the preceding figure but split by DGP architecture, with design as the fill. At the null the two architectures are a bit-identical data-generating process, so the two panels coincide up to Monte Carlo noise. Dashed line at nominal 0.05.

Table 3: Power and non-convergence at  $N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ , Hybrid design, dev grid (150 reps per cell), for all five analysis methods across the DGP-architecture combinations present in the dev grid.

| Arch | DGP         | t1/2 | spec    | Power (MCSE)  | Non-conv |
|------|-------------|------|---------|---------------|----------|
| A    | exponential | 0    | E1      | 0.933 (0.020) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 0    | E2      | 0.933 (0.020) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 0    | E3      | 0.940 (0.019) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 0    | lme+CR2 | 0.960 (0.016) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 0    | GEE+MD  | 0.927 (0.021) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 1    | E1      | 0.960 (0.016) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 1    | E2      | 0.920 (0.022) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 1    | E3      | 0.960 (0.016) | 0.000    |
| A    | exponential | 1    | lme+CR2 | 0.933 (0.020) | 0.007    |
| A    | exponential | 1    | GEE+MD  | 0.900 (0.024) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 0    | E1      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 0    | E2      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 0    | E3      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 0    | lme+CR2 | 0.966 (0.015) | 0.007    |
| A    | linear      | 0    | GEE+MD  | 0.947 (0.018) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 1    | E1      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 1    | E2      | 0.867 (0.028) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 1    | E3      | 0.960 (0.016) | 0.000    |
| A    | linear      | 1    | lme+CR2 | 0.886 (0.026) | 0.007    |
| A    | linear      | 1    | GEE+MD  | 0.880 (0.027) | 0.000    |

|   |               |   |         |               |       |
|---|---------------|---|---------|---------------|-------|
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | E1      | 0.993 (0.007) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | E2      | 0.993 (0.007) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | E3      | 1.000 (0.000) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | lme+CR2 | 0.993 (0.007) | 0.007 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | GEE+MD  | 0.960 (0.016) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | E1      | 0.973 (0.013) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | E2      | 0.947 (0.018) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | E3      | 0.973 (0.013) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | lme+CR2 | 0.973 (0.013) | 0.000 |
| A | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | GEE+MD  | 0.927 (0.021) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 0 | E1      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 0 | E2      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 0 | E3      | 0.967 (0.015) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 0 | lme+CR2 | 0.987 (0.009) | 0.007 |
| B | exponential   | 0 | GEE+MD  | 0.960 (0.016) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 1 | E1      | 0.727 (0.036) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 1 | E2      | 0.873 (0.027) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 1 | E3      | 0.720 (0.037) | 0.000 |
| B | exponential   | 1 | lme+CR2 | 0.893 (0.025) | 0.007 |
| B | exponential   | 1 | GEE+MD  | 0.847 (0.029) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 0 | E1      | 0.980 (0.011) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 0 | E2      | 0.980 (0.011) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 0 | E3      | 0.980 (0.011) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 0 | lme+CR2 | 0.980 (0.012) | 0.013 |
| B | linear        | 0 | GEE+MD  | 0.953 (0.017) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 1 | E1      | 0.813 (0.032) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 1 | E2      | 0.927 (0.021) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 1 | E3      | 0.813 (0.032) | 0.000 |
| B | linear        | 1 | lme+CR2 | 0.959 (0.016) | 0.013 |
| B | linear        | 1 | GEE+MD  | 0.900 (0.024) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | E1      | 1.000 (0.000) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | E2      | 1.000 (0.000) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | E3      | 1.000 (0.000) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | lme+CR2 | 1.000 (0.000) | 0.020 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 0 | GEE+MD  | 0.987 (0.009) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | E1      | 0.740 (0.036) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | E2      | 0.780 (0.034) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | E3      | 0.740 (0.036) | 0.000 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | lme+CR2 | 0.824 (0.031) | 0.013 |
| B | weibull k=0.7 | 1 | GEE+MD  | 0.793 (0.033) | 0.000 |

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### S1: Sensitivity to within-factor autocorrelation

Hybrid, Covariance,  $N=70$ ,  $c_{bm}=0.45$ , exp DGP (dev, 150 reps)

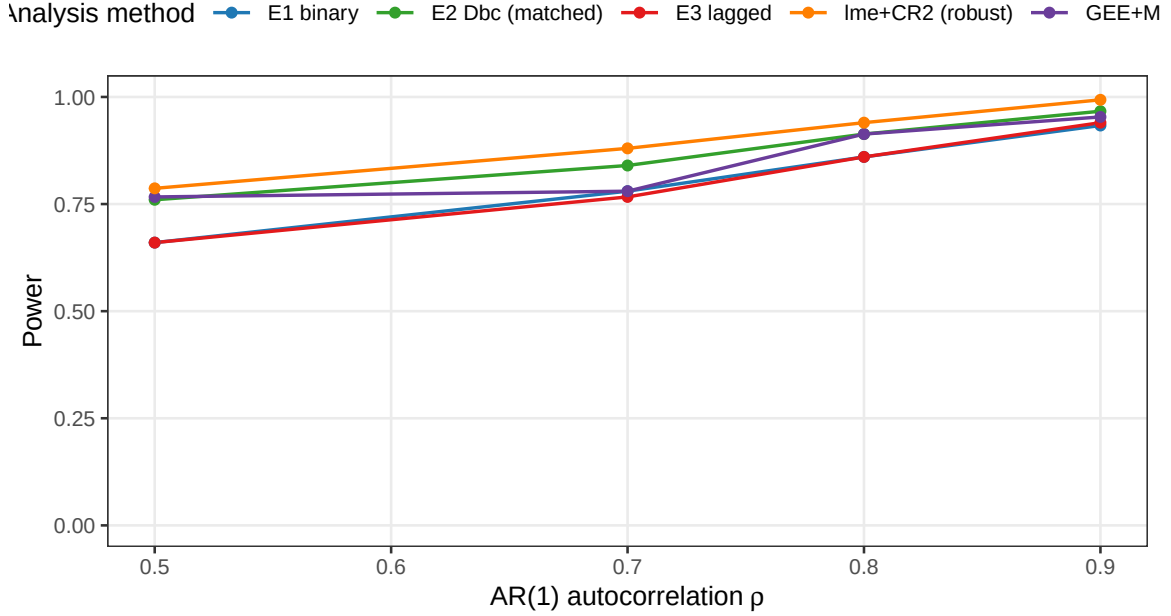


Figure 5: Power by analysis method across AR(1) autocorrelation  $\rho \in \{0.5, 0.7, 0.8, 0.9\}$ . Reference: Covariance, Hybrid,  $N = 70$ ,  $c_{bm} = 0.45$ , exponential DGP,  $t_{1/2} = 1.0$  weeks.

### S2: Cost of analyst-truth half-life mismatch (dev)

E1 and E3 are invariant; E2, lme+CR2, GEE+MD are Dbc-based

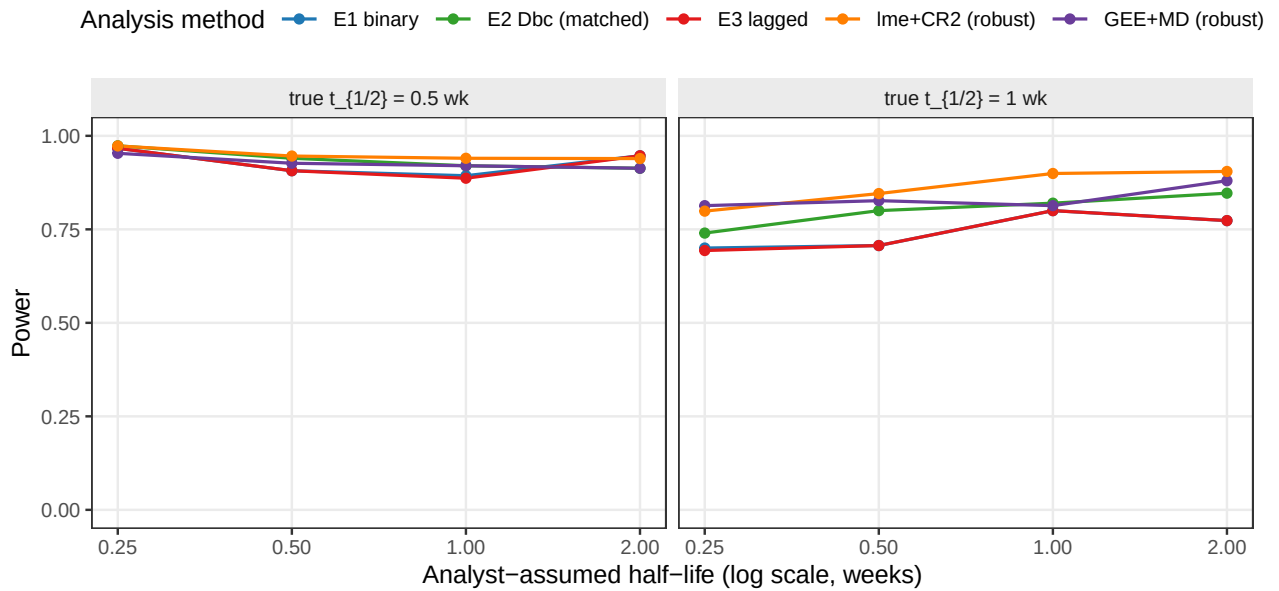


Figure 6: Power as the analyst's assumed half-life departs from the true DGP half-life. E1 and E3 do not consume the assumed half-life and are flat; E2 and the two robust analyses are all built on the  $D_{bc}$  predictor and vary with it.

Table 4: Automated sanity checks against the dev-run results. Thresholds are deliberately loose (MCSE 0.041 at 150 reps).

| Check                                                | Result                            |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| E2 power > E1 power at the reference cell            | E2=0.873, E1=0.727 -> PASS        |
| lme+CR2 power >= E2 power (robust SE recovers power) | lme+CR2=0.893, E2=0.873 -> PASS   |
| lme+CR2 null Type I within 0.015 of nominal 0.05     | lme+CR2 mean Type I=0.050 -> PASS |
| Max non-convergence rate below 0.20                  | Max=0.020 -> PASS                 |

### 3 Tier 2 sensitivity results

#### 3.1 S1: within-factor autocorrelation

#### 3.2 S2: analyst-truth half-life mismatch

#### 3.3 S3: dropout

S3: Sensitivity to dropout (dev)

MCAR and MAR (severity-biased); reference cell as above

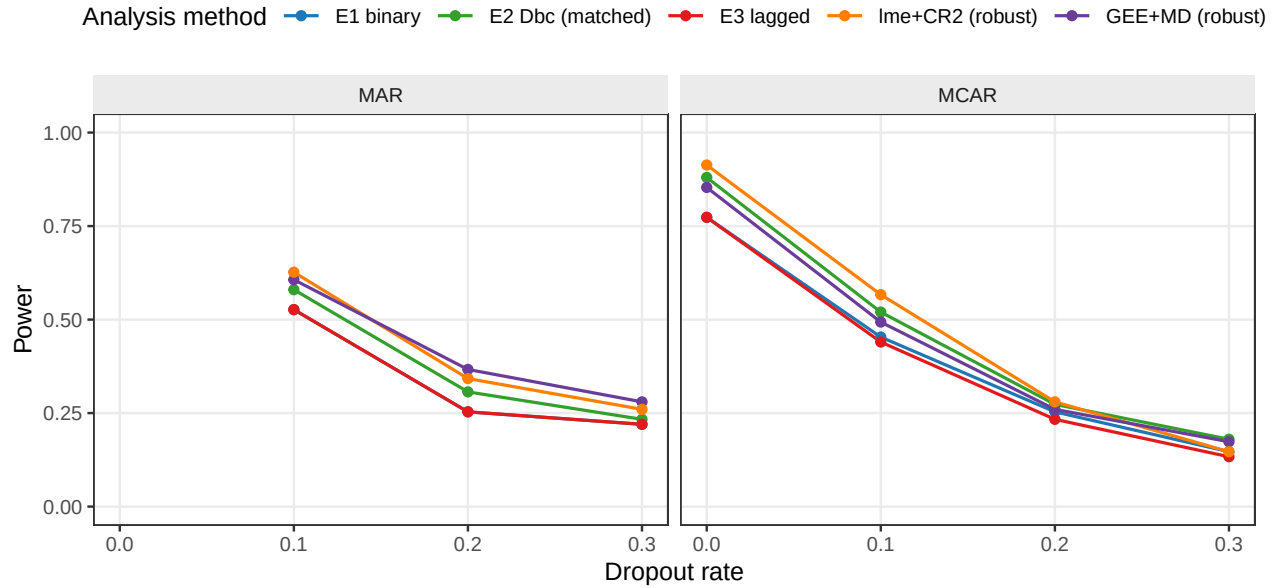


Figure 7: Power at dropout rates  $\in \{0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$  under MCAR and MAR mechanisms, for all five analysis methods. With its exchangeable working correlation GEE+MD runs cleanly across the dropout range, power declining monotonically as expected.

#### 3.4 S4: biomarker-moderation effect-size curve

#### 3.5 S5: autocorrelation by carryover (exploratory)

### 4 Dev-run review checklist

Dev review document rendered from `analysis/report/02-carryover-sensitivity/report-devresults.Rmd` on 2026-07-31 at 11:21 PDT. Source data: `output/01-dev.rds` (72000 rows), `output/04-sensitivity-dev.rds` (23250 rows).



#### S4: Biomarker-moderation effect-size curve (dev)

Dashed line at nominal  $\alpha = 0.05$

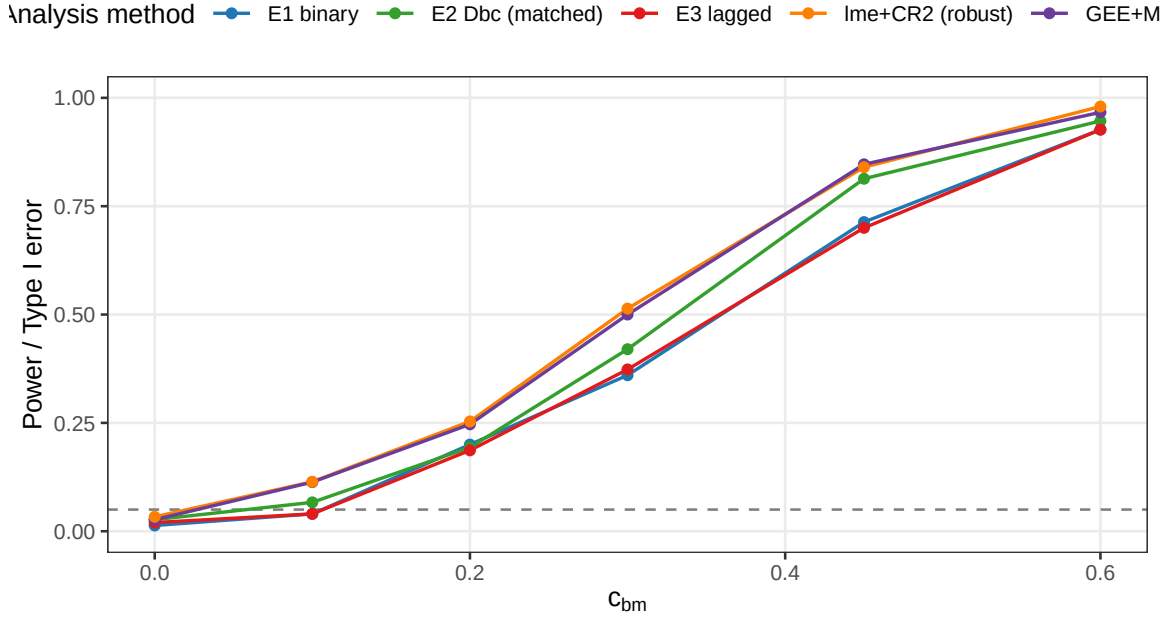


Figure 8: Power across  $c_{bm} \in \{0, 0.10, 0.20, 0.30, 0.45, 0.60\}$ , for all five analysis methods. The  $c_{bm} = 0$  point is the null; dashed line at nominal  $\alpha = 0.05$ .

#### S5: Autocorrelation x carryover interaction (dev)

Is the method ranking rho-sensitive?

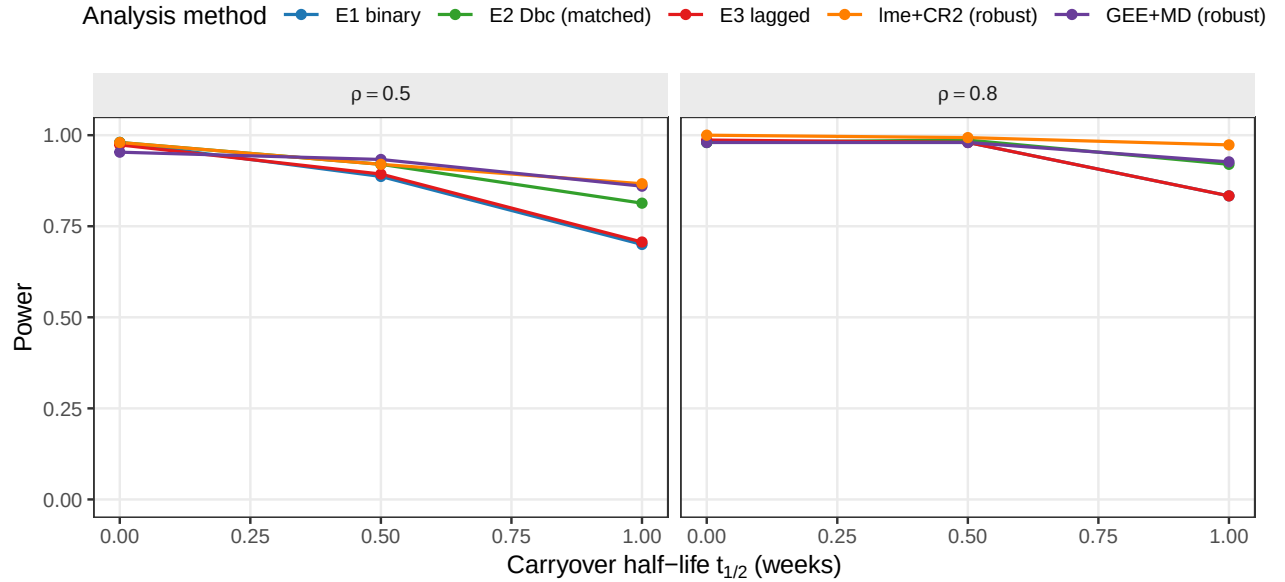


Figure 9: Power across carryover half-lives  $\{0, 0.5, 1.0\}$  weeks at  $\rho \in \{0.5, 0.8\}$ , for all five analysis methods. Facets by  $\rho$ .